
1. eBay

I'll be the first to admit that my top pick for cheap textbooks and student materials is going to fall behind other resources. At one point eBay (Ebay.com) had a strictly enforced rule that prevented the buying and selling of teachers' editions (even those clearly labeled as home educator editions), which left many loyal eBayers in the lurch. Nevertheless, such editions seem to be available again on the site.

2. Amazon

Taking over as my personal #1 resource for buying student and teacher materials, Amazon (Amazon.com) offers copies of textbooks that range anywhere from 99 cents for Kindle edition / \$5 for used paperback to very close to retail value. Older editions of textbooks can be identical to newer ones in content, so do your research to find out if buying that newest release for 50% more will only net you a shinier cover. (How much has algebra changed in the last 10 years, anyway?) The only drawback to using the Amazon sellers' marketplace for finding textbooks is that you purchase sight unseen. Book descriptions are vague, and shipping is not usually

able to be combined. I have had great experience, nonetheless.

3. Homeschool forums

With many parents fed up with auction sites, they have turned to each other for their cheap materials. The best sites for forum-based curriculum listings include Homeschool World (Home-School.com/forums) and Homeschool.com. You may also be able to search on Yahoo! for some forums to get a more local set of listings. I have been successful finding curriculum for my children at reasonable value, and the materials have been in great condition. Most parents on these forums aren't resellers looking to profit; they just want to get enough money from last year's curriculum to buy next year's.

4. Local library

It doesn't get any cheaper than this. While not usually offering textbooks, your library will have some excellent resources for the homeschooling family. This is especially useful for those families following a Charlotte Mason model or who just want to interject some classical reading into their educational diet. By buddying up to your librarian, you may find them consulting you on what types